

TWO-ING THE FIVE

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #135

It doesn't seem like adding even MORE chords to a song is a good idea (!), but it actually serves a purpose. "Two-ing the Five" is a classic way to do so. Here we'll look at the blues as an example of how to do this.

In general, the chords let us know the key and harmony of a song, where tonal home base is. The chords are literally the path through the song, the structure and the form. So, more chords can sometimes offer us a better path, and a stronger structure. Here, we'll work with adding a ii chord before a V7 chord. The V7 chord is probably the most common chord that we run into, so "two-ing the five" is a classic strategy and device used by bebop players.

The Blues - original chords

Original Blues Chords:

- Measure 1: C7
- Measure 2: F7
- Measure 3: C7
- Measure 4: Gm7, C7

Adding ii chords before the V's

Adding ii chords before the V's:

- Measure 1: F7
- Measure 2: F7
- Measure 3: C7
- Measure 4: Eb7, A7(b9)

Adding ii chords before the V's (continued):

- Measure 1: G7, Dm7
- Measure 2: G7, G7
- Measure 3: C7
- Measure 4: Dm7, G7